



TabVM

Your local VirtualBox machines, controlled from the browser like tabs. One brand system for a precise, local, developer-first tool.

[OPEN SOURCE](#)[WINDOWS-FIRST](#)[LOCAL BY DEFAULT](#)

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ESSENCE

TabVM makes a local virtual machine behave like a browser tab — startable, inspectable, and closable without leaving your workspace.

ATTRIBUTES

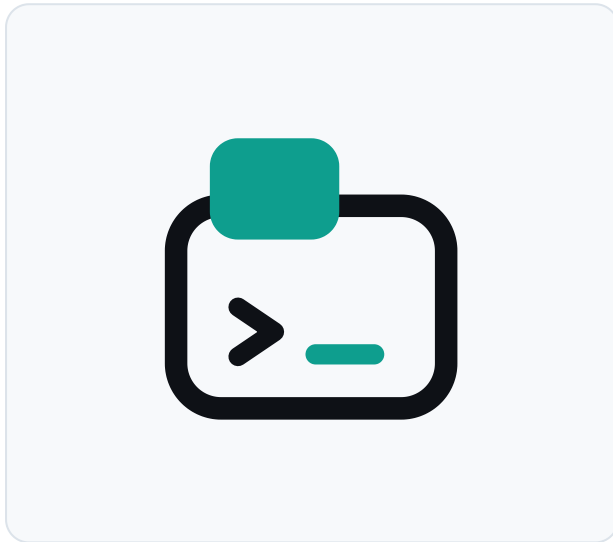
- **Precise** — engineered, not decorative.
- **Local** — it runs on your machine, bound to localhost.
- **Developer-first** — terminal-literate, honest, auditable.
- **Calm** — one accent, lots of quiet, no theatrics.

ONE-LINE POSITIONING

Local VMs, managed like tabs — in your browser, on your machine.

The concept

The mark is not a metaphor bolted on afterward. It is the product drawn literally: a running VM console, sitting inside a tab.



THREE PARTS, ONE STORY

- **The panel** — an outlined window. The VM console the student works in.
- **The tab** — the solid accent shape on top. The hero: this VM lives in a tab, not a separate OS window.
- **The prompt >_** — a terminal cursor inside. Proof the machine is live and interactive, not a static picture.

Read together: **a live VM session, running inside a tab.** That is the entire product in one glyph — which is exactly why it does not look generic. It could not belong to any other tool.

Logo anatomy

The logo is a mark plus a wordmark. The wordmark splits the name into a written part and a machine part.



TabVM

MARK

Pure geometry — renders identically everywhere. Carries the single accent color.

"TAB" — DISPLAY

Set in **Space Grotesk 600**. The human-readable, spoken half of the name.

"VM" — MONO

Set in **JetBrains Mono 500**. The machine half — a deliberate typographic gear-shift.

Variants

Every asset ships in a light and a dark cut. Never recolor by hand — use the matching file.

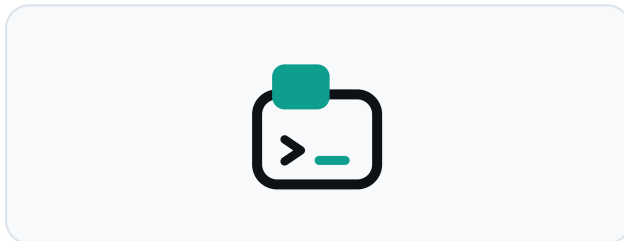
LIGHT THEME — ON LIGHT SURFACES



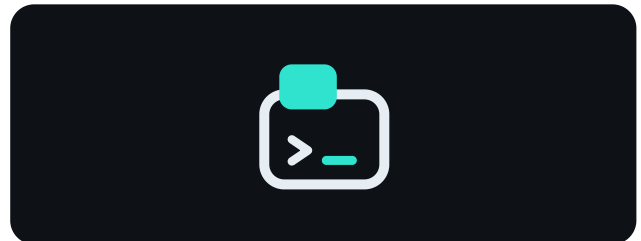
DARK THEME — ON DARK SURFACES



ICON — LIGHT



ICON — DARK

**ALSO ANIMATED**

Each of these has an animated *-animated.svg twin:

the mark assembles once on load, then the caret blinks like a live cursor.

Motion respects prefers-reduced-motion.

Clearspace & sizing

Give the logo room. Keep it legible. When in doubt, use more space and a larger size.

CLEARSPACE = HEIGHT OF THE TAB (X)



Leave at least **one tab-height (x)** of empty space on every side. No text, no rules, no other logos inside it.

MINIMUM SIZES

ASSET	MIN SIZE	USE
Icon	16 px	favicon, tray, tab
Icon	20 px	in-app UI chrome
Full logo	88 px wide	screen
Full logo	24 mm wide	print

BELOW 20 PX, DROP THE WORDMARK



Misuse

The mark stays disciplined. These are the ways it breaks — and they are the fastest path to looking generic.



✗ Don't recolor. One accent only.



✗ Don't stretch or distort.



✗ Don't place on low-contrast color.



✗ Don't rotate or tilt.



✗ No shadows, bevels, or glows.

TabVM

✗ Don't swap the type roles. "Tab" is display, "VM" is mono — never the reverse.

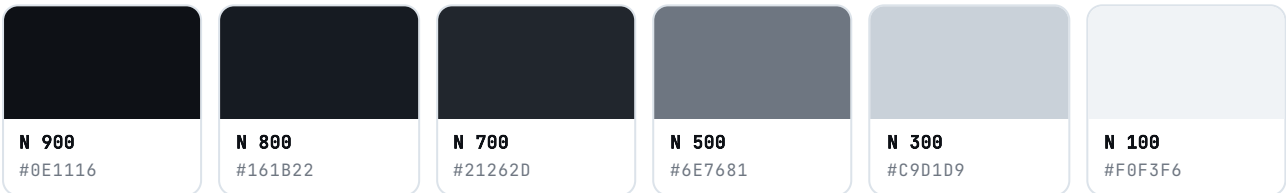
Palette

Cool neutrals do the work; one teal signal marks what is live and interactive. That restraint is the anti-slop rule.

SIGNAL — THE ONLY ACCENT



NEUTRALS — COOL GRAY



LIGHT THEME ROLES

Background	#FFFFFF
Surface	#F7F9FB
Text	#0E1116
Border	#DCE3EA
Accent	#0E9E8E

DARK THEME ROLES

Background	#0E1116
Surface	#161B22
Text	#F0F3F6
Border	#21262D
Accent	#2FE3CE

Usage & accessibility

The accent shifts by theme so contrast holds. Verified against WCAG 2.1.

PAIRING	RATIO	VERDICT	USE FOR
#0E1116 on #FFFFFF	~18:1	AAA	Body text, light theme
#F0F3F6 on #0E1116	~16:1	AAA	Body text, dark theme
#0B7C6F on #FFFFFF	~5.0:1	AA	Small accent <i>text</i> , light
#0E9E8E on #FFFFFF	~3.3:1	AA-large	Large text, icons, UI marks only
#2FE3CE on #0E1116	~11.5:1	AAA	Accent text & marks, dark

DO

- Use **Signal 700** (#0B7C6F) for small accent *text* on light — it clears AA.
- Use **Signal 600** for the mark, links, and large text on light.
- Use **Signal 400** for anything accent on dark.
- Keep accent to roughly <10% of any surface.

DON'T

- Set small body text in Signal 600 on white — it fails AA (3.3:1).
- Fill whole panels or backgrounds with the accent.
- Introduce a second accent hue to “add energy”.
- Rely on color alone to signal VM state — pair it with a label or icon.

Typography

Two open-source faces, chosen so the name reads as two halves: the human and the machine.

DISPLAY · SPACE GROTESK

Aa Tab

Weights 400 / 500 / 600. Used for headings, the “Tab” in the wordmark, and product UI titles. Geometric with just enough character to avoid the default-sans look.

MONO · JETBRAINS MONO

Aa VM

Weights 400 / 500. Used for the “VM”, labels, hex values, code, VM IDs, ports, and terminal output. It is the voice of the machine.

TYPE SCALE (SCREEN)

Display / 52

Manage local VMs

H2 / 30

Start, inspect, close

H3 / 16

Console readiness

Body / 12.5

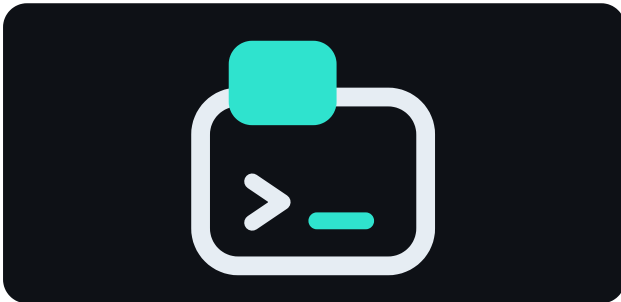
Open a VM console in the browser through RDP, VNC, or a terminal view.

Mono / 12

`VBoxManage startvm <id> --type headless`

Motion

One motion idea owns the brand: the terminal caret. It signals a live machine — the same thing TabVM delivers.



PRINCIPLES

- **Assemble once.** On load: the tab drops in, the panel draws, the prompt appears — in ~0.6s, then it rests.
- **Then the caret lives.** A steady 1.05s blink. Nothing else moves.
- **Ease, don't bounce.** cubic-bezier(.2, .7, .2, 1). No overshoot, no spring.
- **Respect the user.** Under prefers-reduced-motion, everything renders static and complete.

```
tabvm@localhost:~$ _
```

Voice & applications

VOICE & TONE

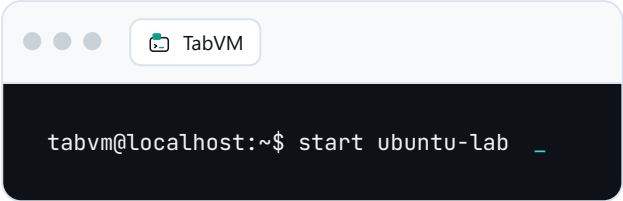
- **Precise over friendly.** Say the exact action: “Start VM”, not “Let’s go!”.
- **Honest about the machine.** Surface ports, states, and errors plainly.
- **Local & safe.** Reassure without alarm: “Bound to localhost.”
- **Lowercase, technical.** Command-like microcopy: start · stop · reset · open console.

APPLICATIONS

 ubuntu-lab · running

 **TabVM** 127.0.0.1

FAVICON & PRODUCT CHROME



ASSET INDEX

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preview.html	live asset gallery, theme toggle